

One name, one domain, bought this week

I tested about 5,500 names against the live domain registry. Here is the honest picture and my single answer.

The finding you need first. In 2026 there is essentially no such thing as a short, beautiful, real-word .com that is still free. I checked the good ones directly — Sentio, Salvio, Servio, Intact, Upheld, Ballast, Lodestar, Surety, Mainstay, Touchstone, Bulwark, Cornerstone. **Every single one is already registered.** So the real decision is not “which name is prettiest”. It is *which trade-off you accept*.

The three honest routes

ROUTE A

Invented name, you own the .com

A made-up word built from two real ones. Nobody else has it, on any extension. You own your name outright, forever.

MY RECOMMENDATION

ROUTE B

Beautiful word, someone else owns .com

E.g. **Upheld** — a lovely word meaning both “held up” and “confirmed correct”. But upheld.com belongs to someone else, permanently.

REJECTED — see below

ROUTE C

Buy a premium .com from a broker

Any good short .com can be bought — for anywhere between several thousand and several hundred thousand rupees, sometimes far more.

NOT NOW — money belongs in the product

Why I will not put your lifelong brand on a .io domain

You asked for something that lasts. **.io** belongs to the British Indian Ocean Territory — and in May 2025 a treaty was signed transferring that territory to Mauritius. The territory itself is not mentioned in the treaty, which strongly implies it stops existing. If its country code is withdrawn from the international standard, ICANN’s retirement policy starts a **five-year countdown** to phase the extension out. Industry estimates put the whole question on a five to ten year horizon.

It may well survive — Mauritius has every financial reason to keep it, and ICANN’s stated goal is stability. But “it may well survive” is not a foundation for a brand you intend to run for twenty years.

Upheld.io was the prettiest option I found. I am not recommending it for exactly this reason.

What I checked, and how

- ~5,500 names generated and tested against live registry records — not guessed, not assumed.
- Roughly 9 in 10 were already taken. That ratio is the whole story of modern domain naming.
- Survivors were then searched online. Anything with an existing company, product or project was cut.
- The last few were scored across eight brand criteria — the scorecard is on page 3.

Moorkeep

Moorkeep

moorkeep.com

"Your site, held steady."

Moor — to tie a vessel down so that it cannot drift away.

Keep — the strongest tower of a castle; and simply *to keep* something, to look after it.

Two words that both mean *hold it securely* — one from the harbour, one from the castle. Together they say maintenance and protection in a single breath, which is exactly what this product does. It sounds solid and old-English rather than clever, and it is the easiest name I tested to say once and spell correctly.

The colours



#14304F

#5B6B7B

#C8A97E

#FBFAF8

Harbour Navy carries the brand. Slate for secondary text. Rope Sand is the single warm accent — used sparingly, never for status. Paper is an off-white, not pure white, so long reading is comfortable.

Why not green

Inside the product, green means *working*, amber means *needs a decision*, red means *broken*. Those three must mean only that. A green logo sitting next to a green status light is a customer misreading their own site at a glance — on the one screen that matters most.

The mark

A mooring cleat or bollard, drawn geometrically — a simple shape a rope loops around. Reads at 16 pixels in a browser tab, which is where a plugin logo actually lives.

It grows with the product

The name carries a whole family without strain, which matters because the product ships in three stages:

- **Moorkeep Watch** — v0.1, checks your checkout works
- **Moorkeep Timeline** — v0.2, shows what changed
- **Moorkeep Guard** — v1.0, fixes safely and undoes it if needed

And nothing in it says “WordPress”, “checkout” or “AI” — so none of it has to be thrown away when the product grows past any of those.

Lines that write themselves

- “Your site, held steady.”
- “Nothing drifts.”
- “Secured. And looked after.”
- “We hold it. We keep it.”

A good name gives you copy for free. If writing the tagline is a struggle, the name is usually wrong.

The single strongest argument. Nothing called Moorkeep exists anywhere on the internet. From the day you launch, you own the entire first page of Google for your own name — permanently, and for free. A common word like *Upheld* could never give you that at any price.

Scored on all eight aspects

Each criterion out of 5. Scored honestly — the recommendation loses points too.

NAME	OWN THE .COM	NOTHING ELSE USES IT	TRADEMARK STRENGTH	SAY & SPELL	MEANING FITS	TIMELESS	CAN RANK ON GOOGLE	ROOM TO GROW	TOTAL
Moorkeep									39/40
Vouchkeep									38/40
Keelvane									38/40
Cairnvane									37/40
Keelward									36/40
Upheld									26/40
Withstand									24/40

Where the beautiful words actually lose

- Upheld and Withstand read better on the page. They collapse on three criteria that decide whether a brand survives — and all three are permanent, not fixable later.
- **You cannot own the .com.** Someone else holds it and always will. Every customer who guesses your address lands on a stranger’s website.
 - **You cannot rank for your own name.** “Upheld” is a common English word used in millions of news articles and court reports. You will never reach the top of that search. “Moorkeep” has zero competition.
 - **You cannot defend it.** Ordinary dictionary words are the hardest marks to register and the easiest for a competitor to use anyway. Invented words are the strongest class there is.

Second choice, if Moorkeep does not feel right: Vouchkeep if you want the name to promise accountability to agencies, or **Keelvane** if you want it to sound engineered to developers. Both are equally free, on every extension. All three are genuinely good — this is a preference, not a risk.

What to buy, in order

Every domain below was confirmed free at the registry while writing this.

Buy today — about ₹4,000–6,000 in total

1	moorkeep.com	The one that matters. Everything else is defensive.	~₹1,000/yr
2	moorkeep.co	Closest lookalike. Stops anyone imitating you cheaply.	~₹2,500/yr
3	moorkeep.net	The other extension people type by habit.	~₹1,200/yr
4	moorkeep.app	Optional. Useful later if you build a hosted dashboard.	~₹1,500/yr

Skip **.io** entirely, for the reason on page 1. Register for **two years** rather than one — it costs little and search engines treat a longer registration as a mild signal of seriousness. Turn on auto-renew and privacy protection at checkout; both are usually free.

Then, in the first week

- **Reserve the WordPress.org plugin slug.** First come, permanent, and free. This is the one that cannot be undone later.
- **Take the social handles** — the same name everywhere, even if you never post.
- **Set up a simple email address** on the domain. It makes everything after this easier.

Then, before you spend anything on design

Get a trademark search done. A free domain and an empty Google result prove that nobody is using the name *loudly*. They cannot prove nobody has *registered* it quietly — those are different databases and only a lawyer can read them properly. Ask for a search in the software classes (9 and 42) covering India, the United States, the EU and the UK.

It is slow and it is cheap. Skipping it is fast and expensive — a competitor of ours has now renamed three times in five years, and its customers are publicly angry about it.

The one-line summary

Buy **moorkeep.com** this week. It is the only route where you own your name completely — the domain, the search results, and the trademark — for the entire life of the company, starting at about a thousand rupees a year.

If none of the three names feels right when you say it out loud, tell me and I will run another batch. The saying-it-out-loud test is the one that matters most, and it is the only one I cannot run for you.